

Gabrielle Sorresso

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Education

PhD, Public Policy, Cornell University 2022–Present
Concentration in Economics

MA, Public Policy

BA, Economics & Environmental Studies, Colgate University 2022
summa cum laude
High Honors in Economics

Research Interests

Health Economics, Maternal and Child Health, Reproductive Policy, Environmental Health, Gender

Research

Peer Reviewed Publications

Sassler, Sharon, and **Gabrielle Sorresso**. 2026. Narrowing the Gender Wage Gap among Computer Science Professionals: What Differentiates the Earnings of Asian and White Workers? *RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences*, 12(3): 98–123.

Working Papers

It Was Already Dobbs: Abortion Bans and Maternal Health

Supported by a grant from the Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy

Clinicians, medical societies, and journalists warned that abortion bans enabled by the *Dobbs v. Jackson* decision would harm maternal health by delaying the treatment of miscarriage and other complications, ending access to terminations for medical reasons, and driving out obstetricians. However, the states that banned abortion after *Dobbs* had already restricted the procedure for over a decade through a variety of regulations and laws. To test the effect of the *Dobbs*-enabled bans on a range of pregnancy-related outcomes, I use detailed health insurance claims covering nearly 1 million pregnancies from conception through postpartum. My empirical design compares outcomes in states that banned abortion with those in states that protected it in a stacked difference-in-differences design. I find minimal evidence that the bans significantly or meaningfully changed maternal health outcomes at the population level. For example, the bans changed the rate of hypertensive disorders by -0.1 percent, and the 95 percent confidence

interval rules out increases larger than 5.1 percent. Other health results are also null and generally precise, as are the estimated effects on the timing and intensity of care. The effects do not appear to be driven by any particular subgroup, and the results are robust to a variety of enrollment samples and specifications. Turning to the channels through which the bans could act, while I find suggestive evidence that fertility rates rose modestly after the bans, the composition of the pregnant population, including its pre-pregnancy health, is largely unchanged. Additionally, OB-GYNs stayed in practice and continued providing routine care. These results imply that restoring the federal right to abortion alone would not appear to be comprehensive enough to meaningfully change the maternal health and care landscape for women.

First Do No Harm: The Labor Market Consequences of a Physician Disciplinary Record (Joint with Amanda Agan and Colleen Carey)

Using a novel dataset of 70,000 state medical board disciplinary actions across more than 40 states (2008–2023), we provide the first evidence on how State Medical Board discipline affects subsequent physician careers. Most disciplined physicians continue practicing—often in a new state and supplying fewer claims—evidence that can inform the optimal design of state oversight and disciplinary actions.

Born After Dobbs: Abortion Bans, Prenatal Diagnosis, and the Prevalence of Congenital Conditions

Abortion bans may change which pregnancies continue after a serious prenatal diagnosis. I test whether bans raised the prevalence at birth of conditions usually detected during pregnancy, such as Down syndrome, relative to conditions that cannot be detected before birth, and follow affected infants through their first year of care.

Hard to Concentrate: Prenatal Air Pollution and Childhood ADHD

Using medical claims for millions of children and Clean Air Act nonattainment designations that required states to reduce fine particulate pollution, I study whether exposure before birth raises the probability of an ADHD diagnosis later in childhood. Preliminary evidence shows that higher county air pollution is associated with more visits for ADHD, anxiety, and depression among children in the same year.

Inequality Within the Family or Within Professions? The Role of Assortative Mating in Shaping the Gender Wage Gap Among Power Couples (Joint with Sharon Sassler)

Conference Presentations

Southern Economic Association (SEA)

Scheduled, November 2026

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

November 2025

Teaching Experience

Cornell University

PUBPOL 2210: Poverty and Public Policy Course Administrator for Maureen Waller	Spring 2026
PUBPOL 2030: Population and Demography Teaching Assistant for Sharon Sassler	Spring 2024
PADM 5310: Applied Multivariate Statistics in Public Affairs Teaching Assistant for Doug Miller	Fall 2023
Colgate University	
ECON 375: Introduction to Econometrics Teaching Assistant for Carolina Castilla	Fall 2021 & Spring 2022

Awards and Fellowships

Irving Louis Horowitz Award for Most Outstanding Project (\$15,000)	2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Cornell Brooks School	Spring 2024
Exemplary Service Award, Cornell Brooks School	2023–2024
Sage Fellow, Cornell University	2022–Present
Award for Outstanding Work in Economics, Colgate University	2022

Professional Service

Cornell University

Gender Equality Representative, Diversity in Cornell Economics	2022–2025
Executive Board Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics	2025–Present
Student Host (twice), Cornell Population Center Speaker Series	2026
President, PhD Student Organization	2024
Mentor, First Year PhD Mentor Program	2023, 2025

Colgate University

Mentor, Women in Economics	2021–2022
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Professional Associations

American Society of Health Economists
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management
Cornell Population Center
Cornell Health Policy Center

Skills and Certifications

Programming: Stata (advanced), Python (advanced), SQL (advanced), R (basic), Matlab (basic), L^AT_EX

Certifications: CITI (valid until 2030)

Citizenship: USA

Dissertation Committee, Cornell University

Colleen Carey (Chair)

Associate Professor of Economics & Public Policy

Doug Miller

Professor of Economics & Public Policy

Nick Sanders

Associate Professor of Economics & Public Policy

Amanda Agan

Associate Professor of Economics